

Cody Adams

Platform Engineering, DevOps & SRE Leader

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Summary

Platform engineering, DevOps, and site reliability engineering (SRE) leader with 20+ years building and operating infrastructure across startups, growth-stage SaaS, and Fortune 100 enterprises — equally effective as a hands-on, full-stack technical owner and as an engineering executive. Career-long owner of incident and change management, BC/DR, data protection, compliance-as-code, and FinOps/cloud unit-economics practices, with a consistent record of SLA adherence and continuously driving down mean time to resolution (MTTR), in 99.9%+ SLA environments throughout. Deep expertise across AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, and Infrastructure as Code (IaC), with a track record of leading SOC 2, ISO 27001, FedRAMP, and NIST 800-53 compliance programs, operating HIPAA-, SOX-, and GDPR-regulated platforms, and executing zero-downtime infrastructure transformations at enterprise scale. Consistently recognized by peers and direct reports for pairing that technical range with genuine, individually-invested leadership.

Career Highlights

- Inherited a \$1.8M budget deficit as Director of Platform Engineering at Opala (March 2025) and closed it to positive within the first year, while owning a \$5–7M annual budget and a 10-person organization.
- Grew Ford’s 2-person “skunkworks” lab into a 150-person organization — including Ford’s first offshore production operations — establishing the enterprise’s Next Generation Data Center function.
- Promoted or expanded in scope in every role held: Plex (Data Center Administrator → DevOps Team Lead), Ford (individual contributor → Director-level contractor), Hoylu (Senior DevOps Engineer → Director of DevOps), Opala (expanded to own Security Engineering & Operations).
- Full lifecycle, full-stack technical ownership at every role — from architecture through hands-on incident response, including debugging across unfamiliar languages and systems when needed.
- Regularly leads large-scale demos and training presentations; owns skills-matrix design, target skills/behavior frameworks, and tooling/integration architecture across every organization led.
- Systems depth few platform leaders bring to the table: expert-level Windows and Linux administration including OS clustering and filesystems engineering, plus Linux kernel development in personal projects.
- Early AI adopter: led Hoylu’s initial AI rollout (2024); at Opala — a Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participant — drives SOC 2/HIPAA-ready AI practices and helped implement a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Core Skills

- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Bare-Metal & Private Data Center, VMware/Traditional VM Hosting, Hybrid & Multi-Cloud (AWS incl. GovCloud, Azure), Cloud-Native (Kubernetes/AKS, HashiCorp Nomad), Landing Zone Architecture (DC & Cloud), Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, incl. COTS/Vendor Platforms), High-Availability & Low-Latency Design, Secure-by-Default Architecture (Edge to Enterprise Fleet Scale)
- **Network & Security Engineering:** DNS & Core Infrastructure Services, WAN/LAN Planning & Operations (incl. PBX/Telephony), Cross-Cloud & Multi-Cloud Networking (Peering, Transit Gateways, Interconnects), BGP, VPN, CDN Architecture, Production Firewall Management, Zscaler (Zero-Trust Access), PKI & Encryption, Blue & Red Team Security Operations, Network & Application Security Engineering

- **Identity & Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Workforce & B2C/External ID), OIDC, SAML, SCIM, SSO/Federation, Zero-Trust IAM
- **Systems Engineering:** Windows & Linux (Expert-Level Administration), OS Clustering, Filesystems Engineering, Linux Kernel Development (Personal Projects)
- **CI/CD & Automation:** Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Bamboo, Octopus Deploy, TFS, Docker, Packer, Ansible, Chef, GitOps, ChatOps, Automated/Self-Healing Infrastructure
- **Release Engineering & Version Control:** Centralized-to-Distributed VCS Migration (TFVC/SVN → Git), Branching/Merging/Release/Deployment Strategy Design, End-to-End Productionization
- **Developer Experience (DX):** Self-Service Platforms, Developer Tooling & Enablement, Shift-Left Operations — since 2012
- **Security & Compliance:** HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001, SOX 404, FedRAMP, NIST 800-53, CSA CAIQ, GDPR, CMS Interoperability, Compliance Automation (Drata), DevSecOps
- **Governance & Resilience:** Change & Incident Management, BC/DR, Compliance-as-Code, GRC Engineering, Immutable & Secure Infrastructure, Shift-Left DevOps, Customer-Facing Technical & Compliance Audits (Pre- & Post-Sales)
- **Observability & SRE:** ELK Stack, Wazuh SIEM, Grafana, Prometheus, AppDynamics, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Azure Application Insights, Incident Response, SRE Practices & On-Call Frameworks
- **AI Enablement:** AI Adoption & Governance (SOC 2/HIPAA-Ready), Databricks Genie AI Workflow Integration, Healthcare AI Applications, CHAI Participation
- **Leadership & Delivery:** Multi-Million \$ Budget Ownership, FinOps & Cloud Unit Economics (COGS Metrics), Org Design & Hiring, Agile/Scrum Coaching (PSM I), ITIL/ITSM, Vendor & Program Management, Board/Executive Reporting, End-to-End Support Model Design (L0 Automation → L1 Helpdesk → Incident/Problem Management → Roadmap), Program Planning (6-Week to 6-Year Horizons)
- **Languages & Scripting:** C, C++, C#, .NET/.NET Core, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, Go, Python, Bash, PowerShell, custom DSLs, YAML/JSON
- **Application & Data Layer:** Reverse Proxies & Web Servers, SQL & NoSQL Databases, Databricks, Message Bus/Queueing, Caching Systems

Professional Experience

Director of Platform Engineering

Opala — Seattle, WA (Remote) | March 2025 – Present

- Inherited a \$1.8M budget deficit and closed it to positive within the first year, while owning a \$5–7M annual budget and a 10-person Platform Engineering organization.
- Expanded role from Cloud DevOps and IT Operations to also own Security Engineering and Security Operations — redesigning the org chart to lead a multi-disciplinary organization spanning cloud infrastructure, DevOps, SRE, cybersecurity, audit/compliance, and corporate IT.
- Established SRE practices, observability standards, and incident response frameworks for a HIPAA-regulated, CMS interoperability-mandated healthcare platform.
- Drive multi-cloud (AWS/Azure) architecture decisions with security and compliance as first-class design constraints.
- Deploy to production daily via IaC and GitHub Actions; built GitHub OIDC federation and centralized DevSecOps policy enforcement across all environments.
- Built Infrastructure-as-Code for Databricks and extensive Python-based access audits; created DevSecOps pipelines and the platform's initial Docker build pipelines.
- Own cybersecurity posture, audit readiness, and the SOC 2 compliance program — including Drata compliance automation with Azure and AWS integrations — positioning compliance as a business enabler rather than a checkbox exercise.

- Hands-on owner of enterprise DNS, firewalls, VPNs, Zscaler zero-trust access, identity lifecycle, endpoint security, developer tooling, and day-to-day IT operations including direct client support.
- Drive Opala's AI adoption — SOC 2/HIPAA-ready practices, Coalition for Health AI (CHAI) participation, and key implementation of a Databricks Genie AI workflow integration and a healthcare AI chatbot application.

Director of DevOps *(promoted from Senior DevOps Engineer)*

Hoylu — Kirkland, WA | August 2020 – February 2025

- Hoylu's first dedicated DevOps/Platform Engineering hire; retained and expanded scope through multiple company-wide workforce reductions.
- Owned the full platform engineering function for a global SaaS collaboration platform serving enterprise and government customers; managed a team of 8 (DevOps and backend engineers) with unified DevSecOps/SRE ownership.
- Reported directly to the VP of Engineering and CEO; designed customer usage-based COGS metrics that gave the board real-time visibility into cloud unit economics.
- Led cloud cost optimization initiatives that materially reduced operational spend while maintaining platform reliability and growth capacity.
- Led ISO 27001 certification end-to-end (achieved 2022) and architected a fully customized SaaS deployment in AWS GovCloud — leading FedRAMP Moderate compliance activities — unlocking enterprise and government customer acquisition.
- Designed a zero-trust, cloud-native platform on the HashiCorp stack (Consul, Nomad, Terraform, Vault) with an automated mutual-TLS service mesh and Wazuh SIEM; self-healing, automated infrastructure supported a public SLA without headcount growth.
- Built 25+ reusable Infrastructure-as-Code modules (primarily Bash and Azure CLI), embedded DAST/SAST and penetration testing into the SDLC, and led Hoylu's initial AI rollout (2024).

DevOps Practice Manager / Cloud Architect

Coretek Services — Farmington, MI | May 2019 – August 2020

- Built Coretek's DevOps consulting practice from zero, delivering cross-industry enterprise and mid-market engagements from initial economic assessment (dozens delivered) through production delivery.
- Led cloud migrations and Azure foundation deployments aligned to the Azure Well-Architected Framework, plus Azure Serverless and Azure DevOps migration engagements.
- Defined and launched the DevOps service catalog (containerization, CI/CD, IaC) using Azure DevOps, AKS, and Terraform; built and trained cross-functional delivery teams spanning staff, clients, and vendors.

DevOps Platform Manager

Delta Dental of Michigan — Okemos, MI | November 2018 – May 2019

- Led development of a Kubernetes-based, metal-up enterprise application hosting platform in a private data center — high availability with no cloud abstraction layer — with direct CTO-level engagement.
- Architected platform-level BC/DR so application teams inherited business continuity and disaster recovery posture by default; maintained federal compliance requirements across the platform.
- Modernized ITSM processes (Change, Incident, Problem Management) and integrated observability tooling (ELK, AppDynamics), reducing central IT dependency through developer self-service.

Ford Motor Company — Dearborn, MI (3 years 3 months)

DevOps Principal Architect – Data Center of the Future | March 2017 – November 2018

- Lead architect and agile coach across a concurrent Platform-as-a-Service portfolio, influencing hundreds of engineers with developer experience as a first-class design concern.

- Replaced foundational infrastructure of a live global operation in real time with zero downtime, embedding compliance and security controls that had not previously existed.
- Delivered platforms including Kubernetes (Containers as a Service), Pivotal Cloud Foundry, SQL Server PaaS, VMware vRealize Operations, IBM API Connect, and F5 iWorkflow network orchestration.
- Established new release engineering practices for IT Operations and trained the Release Manager role into existence.
- Regularly displaced incumbent teams and legacy platforms when the solutions being delivered outperformed them — most notably a full replacement of Ford’s enterprise Active Directory environment, absorbing that team’s scope into the platform organization.

Cloud and DevOps Consultant | September 2015 – March 2017

- Defined Ford’s Data Center of the Future architecture vision across compute, storage, network, cloud, big data, and hosting, with compliance as a first-class design requirement where none had previously existed.
- Designed Ford’s first two purpose-built enterprise data centers — from the rack, power, and cooling level up — and presented the strategy directly to the CIO.
- Established and operated the Next Generation Lab, a production-grade VMware SDDC private cloud proving ground for new platform capabilities, with full asset, service delivery, and vendor management ownership.
- Executed zero-downtime live replacement of foundational infrastructure at enterprise scale, setting new organizational precedents for vendor management and delivery timelines.
- Collaborated directly with Chef co-founder Adam Jacob, HashiCorp co-founder Armon Dadgar, and HashiCorp’s Seth Vargo on core Infrastructure-as-Code tooling and DevOps workflow design as part of Ford’s IaC and automation strategy.

DevOps Team Lead (*promoted from Data Center Administrator*)

Plex Systems, Inc. — Auburn Hills, MI | March 2012 – September 2015

- Full-lifecycle infrastructure ownership in a 24/7, SOX 404-compliant, 99.9% SLA SaaS environment.
- Built the company’s initial CI/CD, IaC, and ChatOps toolchain, driving deployment frequency from periodic to continuous, including blue/green and mid-day production deployments.
- Reduced VM build time by 90% through automation, cutting SOX 404 audit burden in the process — earning the 2014 Q3 “Plex Impact” Innovation Award.
- Primary on-call 24/7/365 for production: rapid response, incident commander, and problem report owner using the 8D methodology.

Earlier Career

Brose North America — Systems Administrator | Auburn Hills, MI | July 2008 – April 2012

- Grew a regional IT role into North American leadership scope, establishing data-driven ITIL practices.
- Delivered a 20% local IT headcount reduction through automation.

Prior: ~3 years of self-employed IT work and PC technician roles (2005–2008).

Certifications & Education

Certifications: Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) — Scrum.org, 2017 | Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — 2019 | Scrum Fundamentals Certified

Education: B.S., Computer Science — Systems/Network Design, University of Michigan–Flint (2003–2010).